

Your name:



The UK Linguistics Olympiad 2022 - Round 2

Solution and marking.

Scoring: (max 85)

4.1: Max 8 - 4 points per correct option. Award 0 points if more than 2 are marked.

4.2: Max 27 – For each answer: 3 points if correct, 1 point with one mistake (length, quality, tone, onset, coda OR extra form)

4.3 Max 50 – For each answer: 5 points if correct, 2 points with one mistake (extra form, missing form, length, quality, tone, etc...)

Q 4.1	àdèen		Cross the correct options (X) and leave the incorrect options blank.		
	mìiit				
	wèeet				
	tôon	X			
	jàak				
	tûun	X			
Q 4.2	(a) lòoj		(d) càam		(g) wjèec
	(b) lòooj		(e) pèec		(h) bòk
	(c) càam		(f) pèeec		(i) bwòck
Q 4.3	(j) réen, rón		(n) rjéem		(r) jîit
	(k) wjèeel, wîiil		(o) kwòck		(s) ànjéer
	(l) réec		(p) lèeek, lêeek		
	(m) kál, kól		(q) rwòcl		

Q 4.4: Max 95 – Broken down as follows:

Noun tone/length patterns: 15

Verb tone/length patterns: 5

Noun vowel patterns: 50

Verb vowel patterns: 25

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Commentary

Vowels come in 6 qualities and 3 grades:

Grade 1	i	e	a	ɔ	o	u
Grade 2	i	e	ɛ	ɔ	o	u
Grade 3	jɛ	ɛ	a	a	wɔ	wo

Singular and plural patterns then correspond by changing the final vowel as follows, with subscripts indicating vowel grades:

- $\acute{V}_1 - \grave{V}V_3$
- $\acute{V}V_3 - \acute{V}_1$
- $\grave{V}V_1 - \hat{V}V_2$
- $\grave{V}VV_3 - \acute{V}V_2$
- $\hat{V}VV_1 - \acute{V}V_2$

In the verbs the pattern is

- Unmarked: $\hat{V}_1$ or $\hat{V}V_1$
- 1st person: $\hat{V}V_3$ or $\hat{V}VV_3$
- 3rd person: $\hat{V}V_2$ or $\hat{V}VV_2$

You may notice certain patterns in the grades. Treating grade 1 as the base, the for all vowels except a, grades 1 and 2 are the same, while grade 3 is lowered. For a, grades 1 and 3 are the same, and grade 2 is raised.

NB: many analyses of the patterns are available, such as proposing only two types of change (here Grades 1 to 3 and 3 to 2) with two different underlying vowels that realise as **a**.

Dinka also features a distinction between “creaky” and “breathy” vowels, but to simplify this problem, it has not been marked.

Source: [Number-- constructions and semantics : case studies from Africa, Amazonia, India and Oceania \[electronic resource\]](#)